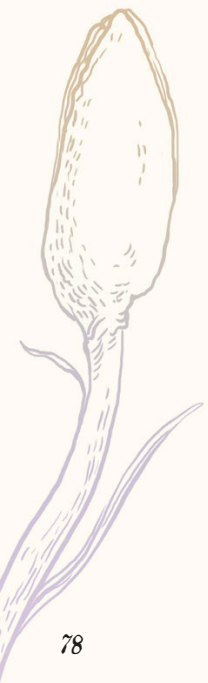




Iris

Huge petals in pretty colours have made irises very popular. They grow from bulbs, like daffodils and tulips, or from fat underground stems. Their showy flowers can be red, orange, yellow, blue, or purple. Many irises have lines or rows of dots on their petals that point to the centre of the flower. These are landing instructions for insects. Like the lights on an airport runway, they show the animals coming in to land where the sweet nectar is.

In Ancient Greece, Iris was the goddess of rainbows. One of her tasks was to carry messages for the other gods – it was said that she could fly as fast as the wind.



Netted iris,
Western Asia

